TULIP

GTM Operations
Take-Home Exercise

Purpose

This exercise uses a real, anonymized export of our CRM. We want to see three things:

1. Whether you can get to a defensible number out of a messy file
2. Whether you can tell the difference between a number that is real and a number that is an artifact of how it was counted, and
3. Whether you can turn that into a recommendation a CRO can act on

Most of this exercise has right answers, and we will check them against the file. Exercises 1 and 2 are largely arithmetic on data you have been given. If your number is wrong, or if it cannot be reproduced from the method you describe, that is the finding. Exercise 3 is judgment, and there we care about whether you can defend the position you take.

We are not asking you to write a data quality report and we are not asking you to build a tool. We are asking for correct analysis, honestly caveated, and one clear recommendation.

Time budget

~Estimated 3 to 4 hours. Suggested allocation:

Section	Suggested time	Deliverable
Exercise 1: Win rate	90 minutes	Workings plus about 1 page of commentary
Exercise 2: Renewals	75 minutes	Model file plus about 1 page of commentary
Exercise 3: Recommendation	60 minutes	6 to 8 slides or 2 pages

If you go well over, stop and tell us what you cut and why. Knowing what to leave out is part of the job. Coming in at or under 4 hours with clean, correct work will be weighted higher than eight hours of exhaustive work.

Materials

Two files are attached to the email carrying this brief. Work from the attachments. There is no shared link and no version of this data that you need to request access to.

File	What it is
GTMO_Take_Home_Dataset.xlsx	1,458 anonymized opportunity records across 43 columns. 711 new-business opportunities (FY25 to FY27), 700 subscription renewals (FY26 and FY27), and 47 hardware and qualification records. Structured fields for ARR, bookings, stage, forecast category, industry, geography, partner attribution, licenses, utilization and health, plus two free-text columns (CSM Health Note, Latest Gong Call Highlight) and a categorical churn reason field.
GTM Context and Data Dictionary	Segments, sales motion, partner channels, fiscal calendar and field definitions. Read it before you open the data. It is the appendix to this brief.

A warning that is also a hint: This export has the hygiene problems a real CRM export has. Columns disagree with each other. Some fields are named one thing and populated with another. Some columns are populated on record types where they have no meaning. We have left all of it. You do not owe us a write-up of what you found, but if you miss it, your numbers will be wrong.

AI tools and format

Use whatever you prefer. Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini, Cursor, Excel, Python, SQL. No restrictions. We will ask what you used, and might ask to see the prompts. We care about whether the answers hold up.

Format for Exercises 1 and 2 is your call, with one requirement: send us the file where the numbers actually live, not only the summary. A spreadsheet with your cuts, a notebook, or a query log is all fine. We need to be able to reproduce the number.

What happens after you submit: 60 minute on-site Panel

Time	Segment	What we are doing
20 min	You present Exercise 3	Walk us through the recommendation. Interactive, we will interrupt.
25 min	Live pressure test	We hand you new information and a stakeholder who disagrees with your numbers. Unprepared, in the room. This is the heaviest weighted segment.
15 min	Your questions	Yours to use.

Come with a position you believe. You will be asked to hold it or abandon it under pressure, and abandoning it for a good reason scores well. The take home is data based, but we are testing your ability to take the data and turn it into strategy. That’s where most of the discussion will be.

Exercise 1: Win Rate

Suggested time: 90 minutes.

The situation. Our board deck reports that new-business win rate improved from roughly 9 percent in FY25 to roughly 19 percent in FY26. The plan being drafted off the back of that number is to put more money behind whatever drove it. Before we do that, tell us whether the number is real.

A. Verify the claim

- Define what counts as a new-business deal for this purpose, and say why that definition is the right one for this decision. The file gives you more than one defensible option.
- Show won and lost counts and the resulting win rate for FY25 and FY26 under your definition.
- Then show at least one other defensible definition available in this data and what it produces for the same two years.
- If the definitions disagree on direction, say which number the CRO should be shown and why. Carry that definition consistently through the rest of your work.

B. Decompose the change

Attribute the FY25 to FY26 change in the reported blended number between two things:

1. What is being counted. How much of the movement comes from a shift in the mix of deal types inside the reported population.
2. Genuine performance. How much comes from cohorts actually converting better.

Give a number for each component in percentage points, and show the arithmetic. The components should reconcile to the total change. A description of the effect without the decomposition does not answer this question.

C. Segment mix model

The appendix gives you Tulip planning assumptions for per-segment win rates. Do not use them as inputs.

- Measure the actual win rate per size segment from the file, for FY25 and FY26 separately, restricted to the population you defined in A. Report the counts alongside the rates.
- Compare each measured rate against the planning assumption in the appendix and quantify the gap.
- Show how the segment mix of closed deals changed between FY25 and FY26.
- Build the mix model: state the blended win rate today, then the blended rate under a stated shift toward the highest-converting segment. Pick a shift you would actually propose and say what it is.
- State the conclusion this forces about segment mix as a lever. If the lever is smaller than the planning assumptions imply, say so and give the number.

D. What this data cannot tell you

Half a page. The two most important things you cannot conclude about the win rate from this file, and the specific data you would need to close each gap.

What strong looks like: You reconcile the definitions before you answer. Your decomposition adds up. You measure the segment rates instead of inheriting them, and you are willing to tell us that a lever everyone assumes is large is small in this data.

Exercise 2: Renewals, Churn and Expansion

Suggested time: 75 minutes. Use the subscription renewal records.

The renewal records carry structured fields (stage, health, sold licenses, utilization, renewal ARR) and two free-text columns (CSM Health Note, Latest Gong Call Highlight). A model built only on the structured fields misses real risk. A model built only on the text is unreliable. We want both, and we want it calibrated against what already happened.

A. FY26 baseline

Measure what actually happened in FY26 from the file: logo churn rate and ARR churn rate on the FY26 renewal cohort. Report both. This is your calibration anchor. Industry benchmarks are not an acceptable substitute when the history is sitting in the file.

B. FY27 forecast

- Low, medium and high in-year churn ARR for FY27, with a clear statement of what medium represents.
- Quarterly breakdown of churn ARR across FY27 Q1 to Q4.
- Show the check against your FY26 baseline. If your medium case implies a materially different churn rate than FY26 actually delivered, explain what changed.
- One or two sentences on where the model is weakest, by segment, stage or quarter.

C. Use the text

Your risk scoring has to use the two free-text columns alongside the structured fields. Tell us:

- The categories you extracted from the text, for example champion loss, budget pressure, competitive displacement, M and A, product gap.
- How many renewal accounts fall into each category.
- How you handled disagreement between the text and the structured fields.

D. Conflict accounts

Find three FY27 renewal accounts where the free text materially changes the conclusion you would draw from the structured fields alone. At least one in each direction: an account that looks fine on the numbers and is not, and an account that is flagged as trouble where the text tells you the flag is

stale or overstated. One sentence on the conflict, one sentence on your conclusion. Name the accounts.

E. Expansion sizing

The method is fixed here so that there is a single right answer. Use it exactly:

3. Take FY27 renewal records where Utilization 1 Month Ago is greater than 1.0.
4. Additional seats = Sold Licenses x (Utilization - 1), rounded up to whole seats.
5. Price per seat = that account own Renewal ARR divided by its Sold Licenses.
6. Expansion ARR = additional seats x price per seat.

Report the account count, total additional seats, total expansion ARR, and the split by fiscal quarter. Then one or two sentences on what would make this number wrong in practice, and which accounts you would not actually pursue.

F. The field you would not trust

Name one structured field in this file that you would not use as a churn predictor, and show the evidence from the data that justifies dropping or discounting it. One short paragraph with the number that makes the case.

What strong looks like: You calibrate to the history in the file. Your text extraction changes the answer rather than decorating it. You find the accounts a leader would raise unprompted in a QBR, in both directions. Your expansion number reproduces exactly from the method we gave you.

Exercise 3: The Recommendation

Suggested time: 60 minutes. A deck or a memo, whichever you prefer. You will present it in the panel.

Tulip is a land and expand business. We land small in one team or one site, then expand into adjacent teams, sites and use cases over several years. Based on what you found in Exercises 1 and 2, tell the CRO what to do differently.

One recommendation. Not a menu of options and not a balanced survey of considerations. Four things have to be in it:

#	Element	What it means
1	The recommendation, up top	One paragraph or one slide. What Tulip should do differently and starting when. A reader who stops there should know your position.
2	One number that carries it	A single number from your own Exercise 1 or 2 work, with the cut you made to get it. Not a model, not three scenarios. One number you would put in front of the board.
3	What stops, what starts, in what order	Say what gets deprioritized so this can be funded, and be concrete about the effect on a real function: marketing spend, SDR and AE focus,

#	Element	What it means
		partner channel, CSM coverage, pricing. Then sequence it. What ships in the first 90 days, what in the first year, and who owns each piece.
4	Two things you might be wrong about	Name them. For each, give the tripwire: the specific observable that would tell you within a quarter that you were wrong.

Operational specificity matters here. "Focus on mid-market" is not a recommendation. "Move two of the four SMB-facing AEs onto the mid-market pod in Q3, and stop funding the SMB paid search line that feeds them" is.

What we're assessing:

Five axes. Accuracy carries more weight in this version than it has previously, because most of what we are asking has a checkable answer.

Dimension	Weight	What good looks like
Accuracy	30%	The numbers reconcile to the file. Definitions are stated and carried consistently. Your method reproduces when we run it.
Point of view	25%	You take a position, sequence ruthlessly, and can say what would change your mind. You hold it under pressure and you update when given a good reason.
Operating clarity	20%	Your analysis becomes a process, a decision, a hire or a reallocation, with an owner, a trigger and a way to know if it is working.
Signal extraction	15%	You combine structured fields and free text so that the combination changes the answer. You find the accounts that matter in both directions.
Calibration	10%	You anchor to history in the file, you say where your work is weak, and you flag what the data cannot support.

On scope: we read the time you spent as a signal. Substantially overshooting the budget counts against Point of View and Operating Clarity.

Good luck. If anything here is unclear, send a question. We would rather answer it than have you guess.